

Porchetta Dinner

3 pax + leftovers · 26 June 2026

1. Porchetta with Salsa Verde
2. Crispy Roast Potatoes with Garlic, Lemon Zest & Flaky Salt
3. Charred Radicchio & Raw Fennel Salad
4. Warm Cannellini Beans with Garlic & Olive Oil
5. Chilled Orange with Olive Oil & Flaky Salt

Portion note: Potatoes and beans together are substantial. For lighter appetites, omit one or the other — if retaining only one, keep the salad.

SHARED PREP

Lemons — 2 total: prep differs by timing.

Lemon 1: zest only → Porchetta paste (at roll assembly, T-24 to T-18).

Lemon 2: zest of ½ → Potato finish; juice of ½ → Salad dressing. Both at service — zest and juice Lemon 2 together at T-0:04.

Garlic — 13 medium cloves + 1 small: prep differs per dish, do not aggregate.

6 cloves → Porchetta paste (process with herbs) · 3 cloves → Potatoes (crush lightly, add halfway through roast) · 3 cloves → Beans (slice thin at T-1:05) · 1 small clove → Salsa verde (mince fine at T-1:05)

SHOPPING LIST

Ingredient	Total	Porc./SV	Pot.	Salad	Beans	Orange
PROTEIN / MEAT						
Pork belly, skin-on	1.8–2.2 kg / 4–5 lb	1.8–2.2 kg	—	—	—	—
Pork loin, centre-cut	700–900 g / 1.5–2 lb	700–900 g	—	—	—	—
PRODUCE						
Fennel bulb, small	1	—	—	1	—	—
Garlic (pantry check)	13 med + 1 small	6 + 1 sm	3 crushed	—	3 sliced	—
Lemons	2	1 (zest)	½ zest	½ juice	—	—
Mint	10 g	10 g (SV)	—	—	—	—
Oranges	3	—	—	—	—	3
Parsley	20 g	20 g (SV)	—	—	—	—
Potatoes, Yukon Gold	900 g / 2 lb	—	900 g	—	—	—
Radicchio, small	1	—	—	1	—	—
Rosemary	8 g	8 g	—	—	—	—
Sage	6 g	6 g	—	—	—	—
PANTRY / DRY						
Butcher's twine (pantry check)	1 roll	✓	—	—	—	—
Capers	15 g	15 g (SV)	—	—	—	—
Cannellini beans, canned	2 × 400 g cans	—	—	—	2 cans	—
Fennel seed	12 g	12 g	—	—	—	—
Peppercorns, black (pantry)	3 g	3 g	—	—	—	—
Red pepper flakes (pantry)	5 g	5 g	—	—	—	—
OILS & LIQUIDS						
Neutral oil (pantry check)	5 ml / 1 tsp	5 ml	—	—	—	—
Olive oil	~190 ml / ¾	110 ml	—	30 ml	30 ml	15 ml

Ingredient	Total	Porc./SV	Pot.	Salad	Beans	Orange
	cup					
Red wine vinegar	30 ml / 2 tbsp	30 ml (SV)	—	—	—	—
SEASONING						
Diamond Crystal kosher salt (pantry)	~45 g total	28 g	8 g	5 g	5 g	—
Flaky salt (pantry check)	small qty	finish	finish	—	—	finish
Black pepper (pantry check)	small qty	paste	—	to taste	to taste	—

Sourcing: One parsley bunch covers salsa verde (20 g). Lemon 1 zested at assembly (T-24); Lemon 2 zested and juiced at service (T-0:04) — do not zest in advance. Olive oil: ~190 ml total, one 500 ml bottle covers all dishes.

MEAL WORKFLOW

Critical path: Rendering complete before crackling phase → crackling phase → 30-minute steam-free rest governs service. Do not delay slicing for side synchronisation. If crackling runs long, sacrifice potato crispness and bean temperature — protect crackling integrity and pork temperature.

T-MINUS TIMELINE

Time	Action
T-24 to T-18	Salt and roll porchetta. Tie every 2.5 cm. Salt skin. Air-dry uncovered on rack over tray in refrigerator.
T-2:45	Begin rendering phase — oven 300°F / 150°C, middle rack, elevated wire rack over tray. (1 hr 45 min–2 hr 10 min)
T-2:00	Reserve 45–60 ml / 3–4 tbsp rendered pork fat from drip tray for potatoes.
T-1:05	Start beans on Burner 1. Make salsa verde. Char radicchio cut-side down in cast-iron on Burner 2 (60–90 sec). Slice fennel thinly.
T-0:55	Parboil potatoes in well-salted water on Burner 2 — 12–14 min (outer layer yields, centre still firm).
T-0:52	Raise oven to 475°F / 245°C. Crackling phase begins. (15–25 min)
T-0:42	Drain potatoes. Rough surfaces aggressively in pot until shaggy. Hold uncovered on tray — 10 min surface drying before oven entry.
T-0:32	Remove porchetta. Rest uncovered on elevated rack (30 min — do not tent). Potatoes enter oven immediately in reserved pork fat at 475°F / 245°C.
T-0:10	Remove potatoes. Hold uncovered on rack.
T-0:04	Zest and juice Lemon 2. Dress salad. Final seasoning on beans.
T-0:02	Finish potatoes with lemon zest and flaky salt. Slice porchetta (remove twine; 1–1.5 cm slices).
T-0:00	SERVE — Beans → Potatoes → Porchetta → Salsa verde → Salad. Window: 5–7 min. First failure if delayed: crackling softens.

Critical path: Rendering must be complete before crackling phase — premature high heat is the primary failure mode. Once oven raises to 475°F at T-0:52, potatoes hold dry on tray. Porchetta 30-minute rest is non-negotiable; do not begin slicing before T-0:02.

Oven sequencing: 300°F / 150°C for rendering (Burner 1: beans; Burner 2: potato parboil from T-0:55, cast-iron radicchio char at T-1:05 clears well before parboil). Raise to 475°F / 245°C at T-0:52 for crackling. Oven remains at 475°F continuously through potato roast — no second transition. Potatoes enter the vacated oven at T-0:32 at full temperature.

HOLDING CHAIN

Component	Hold Strategy	Max Hold	Drift Risk	Corrective Action
Porchetta	Elevated rack, uncovered, airflow underneath	30 min	Crackling softens	Return uncovered to 475°F / 245°C for 5–7 min before slicing
Potatoes	Uncovered on rack, room temp	10–15 min	Crust softens progressively	No recovery — serve as promptly as possible; never cover
Beans	Covered on very low heat	30 min	Tighten and thicken	Loosen with 1–2 tbsp warm water before serving
Salad	Undressed, refrigerated	Until T-0:04	Wilting if dressed early	Dress only at T-0:04 — never before
Salsa verde	Room temperature, covered	2 hours	Herb oxidation over time	Prepare at T-1:05; use within 2 hours

Porchetta with Salsa Verde

Yield: 6–8 · Total: ~24 hr (incl. drying) · Active: ~35 min · Oven: 300°F → 475°F / 150°C → 245°C · Rest: 30 min

Three-texture porchetta — shattered crackling, rendered belly fat, juicy loin centre — with mandatory salsa verde delivering the meal's primary acid balance and preventing palate fatigue across a full serving.

INGREDIENTS

PORK	
Skin-on pork belly	1.8–2.2 kg / 4–5 lb
Centre-cut pork loin	700–900 g / 1.5–2 lb
SALT CURE	
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	18 g
HERB-FENNEL PASTE	
Fennel seed, lightly toasted	12 g
Black peppercorns	3 g
Garlic cloves	6
Rosemary leaves	8 g
Sage leaves	6 g
Lemon zest (Lemon 1)	1 lemon
Red pepper flakes	5 g
Olive oil	30 ml / 2 tbsp
SKIN	
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	8 g
Neutral oil	5 ml / 1 tsp
SALSA VERDE	
Parsley leaves	20 g
Mint leaves	10 g
Capers	15 g
Garlic clove, small	1
Red wine vinegar	30 ml / 2 tbsp
Olive oil	80 ml / ⅓ cup
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	2 g
Black pepper	to taste

PREP PHASE

Critical path: full fat rendering before blistering phase. Overnight drying is non-negotiable. Salsa verde prepared at T-1:05 during rendering.

- Belly:** Butterfly thicker areas to create an even slab ~1.5 cm / 0.6 in throughout. Make shallow horizontal cuts through thick interior sections only — do not cut through skin. Verify thickness end-to-end. Pat completely dry.
- Loin:** Trim silver skin. Orient loin so its grain runs parallel to the long axis of the roll — crosswise slicing at carving cuts across the grain of both belly and loin simultaneously.
- Salt cure:** Rub 18 g salt directly onto meat surfaces of both belly and loin. Rest 30–60 min refrigerated.
- Paste:** Combine fennel seed, peppercorns, garlic, rosemary, sage, lemon zest, chili flakes, olive oil. Process to a coarse paste.
- Assemble:** Rub paste over meat surfaces. Centre loin on belly. Roll tightly skin-side out. Tie every 2.5 cm / 1 in with butcher's twine.
- Dry-brine:** Rub skin with 8 g salt. Place uncovered on wire rack over tray in refrigerator 18–30 hours. Before roasting: skin must feel dry and tacky — not damp or cool. If moisture beads remain, continue drying.

ACTIVE COOKING

Temper

Remove from refrigerator 60 min before roasting. Pat skin dry. Rub with neutral oil. Optional for weaker ovens: skewer perforations through skin every 2–3 cm / 1 in — do not deeply score.

Rendering Phase — 300°F / 150°C

Middle rack, elevated wire rack over tray. Cook until loin centre reaches 130°F / 54°C and fat beneath skin appears translucent rather than opaque white. Approx. 1 hr 45 min–2 hr 10 min. Secondary cue: fat feels softened rather than rubbery when pressed lightly with tongs — if still firm and opaque, continue.

Crackling Phase — 475°F / 245°C

Roast 15–25 min, rotating as needed. Pull when crackling is deeply blistered and audibly crisp when tapped, and loin centre reaches 142°F / 61°C. Carryover: final ~145°F / 63°C. Secondary cue: probe enters loin centre with light resistance like warm butter — springy or tight means continue.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Rest uncovered on elevated wire rack over tray or board — 30 minutes. Do not tent. Trapped steam softens crackling; elevated airflow prevents underside steaming.

If crackling softens during rest: return uncovered to 475°F / 245°C for 5–7 min before slicing.

Salsa verde: finely chop parsley, mint, capers, garlic. Combine with vinegar, oil, salt, pepper. Hold at room temperature up to 2 hours.

Remove twine. Slice 1–1.5 cm / 0.4–0.6 in. Serve immediately with salsa verde.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Severity	Failure Mode & Cue	Recovery
Critical	Wet skin entering oven — skin feels damp or cool rather than dry and tacky before roasting	Extend uncovered refrigeration 6–12 h; unrecoverable once roasting begins
Critical	High heat before full rendering — fat layer opaque white and firm at start of crackling phase	Return to 300°F / 150°C; continue until fat turns translucent and softens; retry crackling phase
Major	Loose rolling — visible gaps or movement inside roll when lifted before roasting	Re-roll and re-tie tightly before roasting
Major	Excessive blistering — skin transitions to dark mahogany with acrid aroma during crackling phase	Remove immediately; lightly scrape isolated burnt spots if limited in area

Adjust: Increase salsa verde quantity if pork reads heavy; add additional salsa verde at the plate rather than applying citrus directly to the meat.

Crispy Roast Potatoes

with Garlic, Lemon Zest & Flaky Salt · Yield: 3–4 · Parboil: 12–14 min · Roast: 20–30 min at 475°F / 245°C

Crisp starch contrast cooked in reserved pork fat; lemon zest at finish adds aromatic brightness without introducing another sauce.

INGREDIENTS

Yukon Gold potatoes, peeled	900 g / 2 lb
Reserved rendered pork fat	45–60 ml / 3–4 tbsp
Garlic cloves, lightly crushed	3
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	8 g
Lemon zest, finely grated (Lemon 2, ½ lemon)	½ lemon
Flaky salt	to finish

PREP PHASE

Cut into large chunks. Parboil in well-salted water 12–14 min until outer layer yields easily, centre still firm. Drain. Rough surfaces aggressively in pot until edges look shaggy. Hold uncovered on tray — 10 min surface drying before oven entry. Do not cover.

ACTIVE COOKING

Roast at 475°F / 245°C in reserved pork fat, 20–30 min. Add crushed garlic halfway through. Stop when deep golden crust forms and potatoes are audibly crisp when shaken in tray.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Hold uncovered on rack up to 10–15 min. Finish with finely grated lemon zest and flaky salt immediately before serving.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Severity	Failure Mode & Cue	Recovery
Critical	Insufficient roughing — smooth potato exterior after draining with no shaggy edges; crust will be thin and weak	Return to pot; shake vigorously until surfaces look shaggy before roasting

Charred Radicchio & Raw Fennel Salad

Yield: 3 · Prep: 15 min · Active: 5 min · Dress at service only

Bitterness, crunch, and temperature contrast — raw fennel brings volatile anise freshness structurally distinct from the porchetta's toasted fennel seed.

INGREDIENTS

Radicchio, small	1
Fennel bulb, small	1
Olive oil	30 ml / 2 tbsp
Lemon juice (Lemon 2, ½ lemon)	~15 ml / 1 tbsp
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	5 g
Black pepper	to taste

PREP PHASE

Quarter radicchio through the core. Slice fennel very thinly on a mandoline or by hand. Refrigerate undressed until T-0:04.

ACTIVE COOKING

Heat a cast-iron pan over high heat until very hot. Place radicchio quarters cut-side down. Char 60–90 sec without moving. Remove when outer leaves lightly charred but interior structure remains firm.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Combine charred radicchio and raw fennel. Dress immediately before serving with olive oil, lemon juice, salt, and pepper.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Severity	Failure Mode & Cue	Recovery
Major	Overcooking radicchio — collapsed leaves, no crunch remaining; monitoring required at 60 seconds	Unrecoverable; monitor closely during char

Adjust: Increase lemon juice if salad reads too bitter.

Warm Cannellini Beans

with Garlic & Olive Oil · Yield: 3–4 · Prep: 5 min · Active: 15 min · Hold: 30 min max

Soft earthy buffer that absorbs pork juices on the plate without introducing creaminess or competing with either crisp component.

INGREDIENTS

Cannellini beans, canned, drained & rinsed	2 × 400 g cans
Olive oil	30 ml / 2 tbsp
Garlic cloves, sliced thin	3
Diamond Crystal kosher salt	5 g
Black pepper	to taste

PREP PHASE

Drain and rinse beans. Slice garlic thin.

ACTIVE COOKING

Heat olive oil over medium-low. Cook garlic until translucent and fragrant, 2–3 min — no browning. Add beans; warm through 8–10 min until some beans begin lightly collapsing at the edges.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Hold covered on very low heat up to 30 min. If beans tighten, loosen with 1–2 tbsp warm water before serving.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Severity	Failure Mode & Cue	Recovery
Major	Browning garlic — edges darkening, aroma turns sharp before beans are added	Discard; restart garlic in clean oil

Adjust: Add a small spoonful of salsa verde if beans read flat.

Chilled Orange with Olive Oil & Flaky Salt

Yield: 3 · Prep: 10 min · Chill: 30 min minimum

Cold, bitter-acid palate reset after rendered pork fat — a palate cleanser, not a conventional sweet dessert; set this expectation with guests in advance.

INGREDIENTS

Oranges	3
Olive oil, good quality	15 ml / 1 tbsp
Flaky salt	to finish

PREP PHASE

Peel oranges fully, removing all pith. Slice into rounds. Refrigerate 30 min minimum.

HOLDING & ASSEMBLY

Drizzle lightly with olive oil. Finish with flaky salt immediately before serving.

CRITICAL CONTROL POINTS

Severity	Failure Mode & Cue	Recovery
Minor	Excess olive oil — pooling on plate, greasy mouthfeel	Blot lightly with kitchen paper